

Nimesh Kumar on TrueFan AI's Vision and Impact

Purpose

Founder Nimesh Kumar, from a Baniya Marwadi family and IIT Kharagpur engineering background, shares the journey and vision of TrueFan AI - an AI-powered video communications platform revolutionizing enterprise engagement through scalable, personalized, and multilingual AI-generated videos.

Key Takeaways

- TrueFan AI enables enterprises to create personalized, on-demand AI video content using cloned face and voice models from just 5 minutes of input.
- Video is positioned as the most efficient form of communication, surpassing text and voice, especially in India's multilingual and fragmented market.
- The platform powers external and internal communications across BFSI, healthcare, retail, and entertainment, increasing adoption by **60%** and transforming customer, agent, and employee engagement.
- TrueFan AI has created **2 crore AI videos** in one year, serves **145 enterprises**, and works with major brands like Bajaj Finance, SBI Life, HDFC, ICICI, and Adani Wilmar.
- A shift is underway from costly, production-heavy video creation to AI-driven, real-time, conversational, and synchronous video interactions.

Founding Journey and Vision

Nimesh Kumar began his career at Parthenon (now EY), traveling to **18+ countries** in a year, before joining Warburg Pincus, a leading private equity firm covering **40% of India's stock market** through technology and BFSI investments. Exposure to Indian entrepreneurs inspired him to launch TrueFan AI in **February 2020**, just before the pandemic.

The launch, marked as "perfect bad timing," tested resilience but validated the need for scalable digital communication. TrueFan AI emerged as a solution to make video communication **accessible, affordable, and asynchronous** - transforming it from a high-friction medium into an on-demand tool.

Core Technology and Capabilities

TrueFan AI is a proprietary AI video platform that:

- Takes **5 minutes** of face and voice recording to clone a digital avatar.
- Generates unlimited **AI-generated videos** in real time, personalized to recipients.
- Supports **200+ celebrities** (e.g., Ranveer Singh, Shah Rukh Khan, Rohit Sharma, Kareena Kapoor) and enterprise leaders (e.g., Sumit Mohta, CEO of Max Life).
- Converts videos across **8+ Indian languages**, enabling regional reach and cultural relevance.

The technology eliminates the traditional video production cycle - planning, shooting, editing - replacing it with instant AI-generated content. This enables brands to move from one-size-fits-all messaging to **localized, personalized, and emotionally resonant communication**.

Industry Applications and Use Cases

1. Enterprise Communications

TrueFan AI serves two core communication streams:

- **External:** Customer outreach, marketing, collections, agent incentives.
- **Internal:** Employee onboarding, training, leadership messages, dealer/distributor updates.

Case Study: Adani Wilmar (Fortune Oil)

- Serves **35,000 distributors** nationwide.
- Replaced text/email with **video-first communication**.
- Uses celebrity or CEO avatars (e.g., Ranveer Singh) to announce incentive programs.
- Result: **60% higher scheme adoption** due to emotional, language-accurate, and trust-based messaging.

Case Study: Axis Max Life Insurance

- CEO Sumit Mohta uses his **AI avatar** to send personalized messages to MDRT award winners.
- Videos reflect seasonal clothing, creating realism.
- Enables scalable leadership connection across thousands of agents, boosting morale and brand loyalty.

2. Conversational AI Video

TrueFan AI is evolving from **asynchronous** (one-way) video to **synchronous** (real-time, interactive) video:

- Enables users (e.g., a farmer or borrower) to **talk to AI avatars** using natural speech.
- Example: A Bajaj Finance customer interacts with an AI agent:
 - Asks: "What loan options do I have?"
 - Receives: "Gold loan of **10 lakhs at 9.5%** or personal loan of **6 lakhs at 8.9%**."
 - AI conducts **liveness checks**, validates PAN, and provides instant disbursement.
- Goal: Replicate human-like, video-first customer service with **zero latency**.

3. AI-Generated Brand Films and Marketing

- Created a full **TV commercial-grade ad for SBI Life** featuring Rahul Dravid - entirely AI-generated.
- No physical shoot required.
- Cost: **₹3 lakhs** vs. traditional **₹50-60 lakhs**.

- Can generate **10+ versions** of the same ad for different policies and translate into **8 languages**, enabling hyper-targeted campaigns.
- Demonstrated at scale: SBI Life used AI to create **900+ ad films** featuring Rishabh Pant and Ravindra Jadeja for employees, customers, and agents.

Market Validation and Enterprise Adoption

- **First enterprise customer:** Zomato (March 2024), which validated the platform's marketing potential.
- **Largest customer:** Bajaj Finance.
 - Engaged in **October 2024** after observing TrueFan's early traction.
 - Launched "**videoization**" - a company-wide strategy to make every customer interaction video-first.
 - Built a team of **150 people** dedicated to video content.
 - Created **17 lakh videos** in 1.5 years across **103 POCs** and **20 active use cases**.
 - Renewed contract for **1 crore videos**, signaling deep enterprise integration.

Technology Differentiation: Proprietary AI vs. LLMs

TrueFan AI built its own **foundational small language model (SLM)** instead of relying on global LLMs, for critical reasons:

- **Global LLMs (e.g., OpenAI):** Trained on massive, diverse datasets - produce "averages", not precise human likenesses.
- **TrueFan's SLM:** Built on **first-party, localized data** (5-minute face/voice clips).
 - Creates high-fidelity, personalized avatars.
 - Cost per video: **₹1-3**, compared to **₹800-900** on global platforms.
 - **100x cheaper**, faster, and more accurate.

This local-first, consent-based model ensures realism, cost efficiency, and scalability.

Legal and Ethical Framework

Video usage is governed by a strict **consent-first** policy:

- Celebrities must give **explicit consent** to clone their face and voice.
- Each video requires **separate approval for distribution**.
- Videos are labeled: "Created with AI with consent from [Celebrity Name]."
- No video is released without approval - ensuring legal compliance and trust.

This approach prevents misuse and builds **trust between talent, brands, and consumers**.

Business Model and Pricing

- **Pricing:** Mix of cost-based and value-based models.
- Early stage: Focus on **logo acquisition** and enterprise onboarding.
- Long-term: **Token-based, usage-driven pricing** (per minute/video).

- High **net revenue retention (145%)** - customers spend **45% more in Year 2**.
- Cost efficiency expected to grow as AI models become more efficient.

Future Vision: The Era of Video-First Communication

Nimesh believes:

- **Text is obsolete** for engagement; **video is the future**.
- Just as email replaced letter writing, **AI video will replace emails, PDFs, and static content**.
- Enterprises will move from "**read this policy**" to "**watch this personalized video from your CEO**."
- Video will become as easy to create as typing an email - **on-demand, real-time, personalized**.

Next Frontier: Synchronous Video AI

- Users will soon **tap a video** and have live, conversational AI interactions.
- Apply to: banking, insurance, education, healthcare.
- Imagine: A farmer in Bihar video-calling an AI agronomist or a patient consulting a virtual doctor.
- TrueFan AI aims to **multiply the time of humanity** - not just celebrities, but every expert.

Conclusion

TrueFan AI is redefining enterprise communication by making video **scalable, affordable, and intelligent**. With a **6-year journey, 2 crore videos**, and **145 enterprise clients**, the platform is at the forefront of India's AI revolution. From **BFSI to pharma to retail**, video is no longer a luxury - it's the **new baseline of engagement**.

As Nimesh puts it: "The future of AI is video."

Action Items / Next Steps

- Explore synchronous AI video pilot for customer service and collections.
- Expand video-first communication to employee onboarding and training.
- Develop multilingual AI avatars for regional markets.
- Integrate liveness check and identity verification into AI video flows.
- Build standardized usage-based pricing models for enterprise scalability.

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